

St. Joseph's Anglo-Chinese School
F.5 English Language
Grammar - Lesson 3: Nominalisation

Nominalisation

Part 1: Proofreading quiz

Each sentence contains TWO errors: one in an inversion structure and one in a relative clause. Proofread the sentences.

Not only online learning saves travelling time, but it also gives students access to courses which is not available in their own schools.
Rarely teenagers verify the truth of what they share online, which make them easy targets of scams.
Only by setting clear screen-time rules parents can protect their children, who often spends hours gaming late into the night.
Never the school has considered banning phones in class, which distracts students from every lesson.
Seldom victims of online scams report the fraud to the police, which make it harder to catch the criminals.

Warm-up: From words to nouns

Write the noun form of each word. The last six words are more challenging.

Word	Noun
decide	
improve	
communicate	
introduce	
regulate	
protect	
explain	
solve	
use	
develop	
aware	
important	
depend	
responsible	
choose	
know	

lose	
prove	
believe	
strong	

Part 2: Nominalisation in formal writing

Nominalisation names an action or a quality as a noun, so that ‘people use phones’ becomes ‘the use of phones’. It packs ideas into fewer words and gives formal writing a more academic tone, and it can also carry an idea from one sentence into the next. Together they are among the clearest signs of a higher band in DSE Paper 2.

Example 1: Verb → noun

Plain:	The school decided to introduce e-books, and students supported this.
More formal:	The school’s decision to introduce e-books won students’ support.

The school’s decision to introduce e-books won students’ support. The introduction of the new system also saved paper and lightened schoolbags, and teachers soon noticed a rise in reading time. Other schools could follow this example with little extra cost.

Example 2: Adjective → noun

Plain:	Students should be aware of online scams.
More formal:	Students should show awareness of online scams.

Students should show awareness of online scams. The danger is real and growing, yet many victims discover the fraud only after money has already been lost, which means the damage is done. A short lesson on spotting false messages would build this awareness early.

Example 3: Because-clause → noun phrase

Plain:	Because people share news very quickly, rumours spread fast.
More formal:	Owing to the rapid sharing of news, rumours spread quickly.

Owing to the rapid sharing of news, rumours spread quickly. A false story can reach thousands of people within minutes, and the difficulty of checking every update means that some readers forward it before anyone notices. Careful readers, therefore, pause and verify before sharing anything.

Example 4: If-clause → noun phrase

Plain:	If the school does not update its computers, online lessons will fail.
More formal:	Without updated computers, online lessons will fail.

Without updated computers, online lessons will fail. The school's plan to renew its equipment, however, has already won support from the Parent-Teacher Association, and teachers have promised to test the new system before the start of term.

Nominalisation as a linking device

Nominalisation does more than tighten one sentence — it can carry an idea from the previous sentence into the next. Turn a verb or adjective into a noun, and open the new sentence with it (usually after 'This', 'Such' or 'The ... of'). The reader moves from an idea already met to a new one, and the paragraph flows more smoothly.

Sentence 1:	Scammers play on panic and speed, so victims act before they think.
Linked sentence:	This <i>reliance</i> on emotion is exactly what the fraudsters count on.
Sentence 1:	Most students are far more aware of online privacy than their parents were.
Linked sentence:	This growing <i>awareness</i> , however, does not always protect them from clever scams.
Sentence 1:	Schools can protect students by teaching online safety early.
Linked sentence:	This <i>education</i> should begin long before students own a phone.

Young people often trust official-looking messages without a second thought, and they seldom check who really sent them. Such misplaced trust is easily exploited: a credible-looking link is all a scammer needs. Such carelessness, in turn, keeps the fraud industry alive.

Watch out: avoid the over-used 'This is because...' and 'This shows that...'. A noun bridge ('This reliance on emotion...') says the same thing in fewer words and earns a higher band.

Part 3: Practice sets

Rewrite each simple sentence using nominalisation. The sentences are about technology and communication, so keep the register formal. The last three sets (4, 5 and 6) are more challenging.

Example Set 1 (Verb → noun)

Simple sentence:	People use social media all the time, so they cannot concentrate on their studies.
Prompt:	Turn the verb 'use' into a noun: begin with 'Students' constant use of ...'.

Example Set 2 (Adjective → noun)

Simple sentence:	Parents worry that young people are too dependent on their smartphones.
Prompt:	Turn 'dependent' into a noun: begin with 'Many parents worry about

	<i>young people's ...</i> ’.

Example Set 3 (Because-clause → noun phrase)

Simple sentence:	Because online games are so attractive, many teenagers neglect their homework.
Prompt:	<i>Replace the ‘Because ...’ clause with a phrase beginning ‘Owing to the ...’.</i>

Example Set 4 (Verb → noun)

Simple sentence:	The government will improve the security of online banking, which will protect customers.
Prompt:	<i>Turn ‘will improve’ into a noun and begin with ‘The improvement of ...’.</i>

Example Set 5 (Adjective → noun)

Simple sentence:	Students are much more aware of online privacy than they were ten years ago.
Prompt:	<i>Turn ‘aware’ into a noun and rewrite the sentence without the verb ‘are’.</i>

Example Set 6 (If-clause → noun phrase)

Simple sentence:	If the government does not control social media companies more strictly, online scams will just keep growing.
Prompt:	<i>Replace the ‘If ...’ clause with a noun phrase beginning with ‘Without ...’.</i>

Part 4: Writing Task

Instructions:

1. Your school magazine is running a series called ‘Life in the Digital Age’. Write ONE paragraph (about 80 words) explaining why online scams have become a common problem for young people, and suggesting ONE thing schools could do to protect them.
2. Nominalise ONE of the words in the word bank below and use the noun in your paragraph. Also add ONE relative clause or ONE inverted pattern (e.g. Not only ... but also ...; Never ...; Rarely ...).
3. Link your ideas: open at least ONE sentence with a nominalised noun phrase that refers back to the previous sentence (e.g. ‘This + noun’).

Word bank — turn ONE of these five into a noun, then use it in your paragraph:
